

FARMERS' MARKET NUTRITION PROGRAM WPPM #800-43

Subject: FMNP Benefits Management Guidelines

Item: Issuance of FMNP Benefits

PURPOSE:

To establish procedures for benefits issuance protocol for the Farmers' Market Nutrition Program (FMNP) provided by the California Department of Public Health/Women, Infants and Children Division (CDPH/WIC).

POLICY:

- I. Local agencies (LAs) must establish a written FMNP benefits issuance protocol to ensure staff issue FMNP benefits to all WIC families in a consistent, fair, and equitable manner.

PROCEDURES:

- I. When developing the procedure for issuing FMNP benefits, LA staff must:
 - A. Offer only one FMNP benefit per household per season with at least one family member who is a current WIC participant in one of the following categories:
 1. Pregnant.
 2. Breastfeeding.
 3. Non-breastfeeding.
 4. Infant after the six-month birthday.
 5. Child.
 - B. Retain the LA FMNP benefits issuance policy and procedures for review and audit for three years following the final payment of the contract.
 - C. Train all LA staff on the issuance policy, including the need to apply the procedures in a consistent, fair, and equitable manner.
 - D. Ensure no conflict of interest exists between LA staff and participating farmers/farmers' markets.
 - E. Comply with civil rights requirements during FMNP benefits issuance and activities.
- II. FMNP benefits must be issued through and documented in the WIC Web Information System Exchange (WIC WISE).
- III. LA staff must not issue FMNP benefits to themselves, their relatives, or close friends. Refer to WPPM 140-10.
- IV. The LA must assess agency-wide FMNP benefit usage at the end of each July to determine the likelihood of using all FMNP benefits assigned to that LA during that

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season in order to maximize the number of FMNP benefits issued to participants statewide.

A. LAs must report these findings to CDPH/WIC by August 1 of each season.

V. The LA must issue all FMNP benefits by September 30 of each season.

AUTHORITY:

[7 CFR §248.7](#)

[7 CFR §248.10\(a\)\(7\)](#)

CROSS REFERENCE:

WPPM 140-10 WIC Services for Employees and Relatives

WPPM 230-10 Priority Ranking System

WPPM 800-41 FMNP Benefits Accountability and Integrity